# JACOB R. SMITH

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## EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics, Middle Tennessee State University (Expected May 2027)
Advisor: Daniel J. Smith

M.A. Economics, Middle Tennessee State University (2025)

B.S. Mathematical Economics & Philosophy, *magna cum laude*, Hampden-Sydney College (2023)

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

Public Choice Theory, Austrian Economics, Political Economy of Regulation, Historical Political Economy

## WORKING PAPERS

*"Distillers and Chemists: Capture by Eligibility in the Bottled-in-Bond Act of 1897"* (job market paper)

Newly digitized state-by-year Internal Revenue panel (FY1887–1908); event-study and difference-in-differences estimates show the Act did not foreclose the rectifying trade — rectified output rose 43 percent — while its eligibility rule, a four-year aging floor where an 1893 proposal would have stamped every bottle, was written around the aged stock Kentucky and Pennsylvania already held (92 percent of bonded bourbon and rye withdrawals).

"*Private Mechanisms for Stopping Diamond-Dybvig Runs: Evidence from U.S. Newspapers, 1889–1929"* (with Daniel J. Smith)

Novel dataset of 544 bank runs from digitized newspapers; codes 40 distinct private mitigation mechanisms, eight not previously documented; 70 percent of runs with a reported response used more than one mechanism.

"*Who Killed the Green Fairy? Temperance, Language, and Wine in the Swiss Absinthe Ban of 1908"* (with Nicholas A. Jensen)

Canton-level records of the 1906–07 petition and the 1908 vote: organized temperance (Protestant share) predicts petition signatures; holding the French-speaking share fixed, a one-point higher share of national wine revenue goes with a 0.62-point higher yes-share, with no wine effect on six unrelated federal ballots.

"*Uncorked: How Wall Street Priced the Repeal of Prohibition"* (with Patricia Hummel and Corey Pendleton)

Event study of alcohol and related-industry stocks around newspaper-dated repeal events, 1933 (CAPM, Fama–French, Carhart): alcohol stocks rose when New York voted for repeal delegates, then fell sharply once Alabama, Arkansas, and Tennessee made repeal certain, consistent with investors expecting competition to erode Prohibition-era profits.

## WORKS IN PROGRESS

"*Crisis and Local Leviathan"*

*"Alms and Ale: A Malthusian Test of Welfare Generosity and Alcohol Consumption in OECD Countries, 1995–2023"*

## OTHER WRITING

"When 'Consumer Protection' Protects Producers from Competition," *The Daily Economy* (AIER), August 11, 2026

## ACADEMIC CONFERENCE PAPER PRESENTATIONS

"Bottled in Bondage", *Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting*. Fort Lauderdale, Florida, November 19–21, 2022

"Distillers and Chemists: Strategic use of the Bottled-In-Bond Act of 1897 by both firms and regulators", *Public Choice Society Meetings*. Plano, Texas, March 14–16, 2024

"Distillers and Chemists: Strategic use of the Bottled-In-Bond Act of 1897 by both firms and regulators", *Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting*. Washington, DC, November 23–25, 2024

"The Father of Food and Drug Law as Strategic Regulator: Dr. Harvey Wiley and the Bottled-In-Bond Act", *Public Choice Society Meetings*. Louisville, Kentucky, March 6–8, 2025

"Panic Before Protection: Bank Runs, Contagion, and Mitigation Measures in the United States, 1889–1929", *Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting*. Tampa, Florida, November 22–24, 2025

"Alms and Ale: A Malthusian Test of Welfare Generosity and Alcohol Consumption", *Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting*. Tampa, Florida, November 22–24, 2025

## COLLOQUIA & WORKSHOPS ATTENDED

Public Choice Outreach Conference, *Center for Study of Public Choice*, GMU (2023)

Harwood Graduate Colloquium on Public Choice, *American Institute for Economic Research* (2024)

Harwood Graduate Colloquium on Defending Classical Liberalism, *AIER* (2025)

Summer Seminars on Classical Liberalism, *AIER*, UIC, UIS, and Wabash College (2025)

Economic Freedom Research Colloquium, *Bridwell Institute*, SMU Cox (2025)

Law & Economics w/ PC Insights Workshop, *Stephenson Institute for Classical Liberalism* (2025)

The Untold Stories Behind Financial Crises Workshop, *INET-YSI-University of Lyon 2* (2025)

"Giving an Effective Job Talk" Graduate Papers Workshop, *Institute for Humane Studies* (2026)

Harwood Graduate Colloquium on Governance and Self-Governance: Vincent Ostrom's Framework, *AIER* (2026)

"Distillers and Chemists: Capture by Eligibility in the Bottled-in-Bond Act of 1897", *Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting* (SDAE Graduate Student Essay Contest winners session). Houston, Texas, November 21–23, 2026

## AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND GRANTS

Winner, Graduate Student Essay Contest, Society for the Development of Austrian Economics (2026)

American Institute for Economic Research Graduate Fellowship (Summer 2026)

Political Economy Research Institute Ph.D. Summer Fellowship, $5,000 (2024, 2025, 2026)

Economic Freedom Research Colloquium Honorarium, *Bridwell Institute*, $3,000 (2025)

Center for the Study of Political Economy Fellowship (2019–2023)

Pi Mu Epsilon, US Honorary Mathematics Society (2022)

Beta Gamma Sigma, International Business Honor Society (2026)

## PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Referee, *Virginia Economic Journal* (2026)

Moderator, panel on Tennessee whiskey regulation, MTSU Special Collections (scheduled April 2027)

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

**Instructor of Record, Middle Tennessee State University**

Principles of Microeconomics (Fall 2026) — in progress

Principles of Microeconomics (Fall 2025) — instructor evaluation mean 4.45/5

Principles of Macroeconomics (Spring 2026) — instructor evaluation mean 4.02/5

Prepared to teach, with adequate preparation time, any undergraduate course in the curriculum; trained for intermediate microeconomics, econometrics, machine learning for economics, money and banking, public economics and public choice, and economic history.

## SOFTWARE

Stata, R, LaTeX; Python (working knowledge)

## EXPERIENCE

**Defense Logistics Agency – Aviation, Richmond, VA** May 2021 – Current

*Post-Award Contract Specialist (Trainee)*

- Federal contract administration under the FAR/DFARS; resolved contract discrepancies with OEM vendors and subject-matter experts

## REFERENCES

**Daniel J. Smith (advisor)** — Professor of Economics and Director, Political Economy Research Institute, Middle Tennessee State University · daniel.smith@mtsu.edu

**Adam Rennhoff** — Professor of Economics and Director of Graduate Programs in Economics, Middle Tennessee State University · adam.rennhoff@mtsu.edu

**Ryan M. Yonk** — Director of Education and Senior Research Fellow, American Institute for Economic Research · ryan.yonk@aier.org